

Companion to Bird & de Moor, Algebra of Programming

§2. Functions and Categories

§2.1. Categories

§2.2. Functors

§2.3. Natural transformations

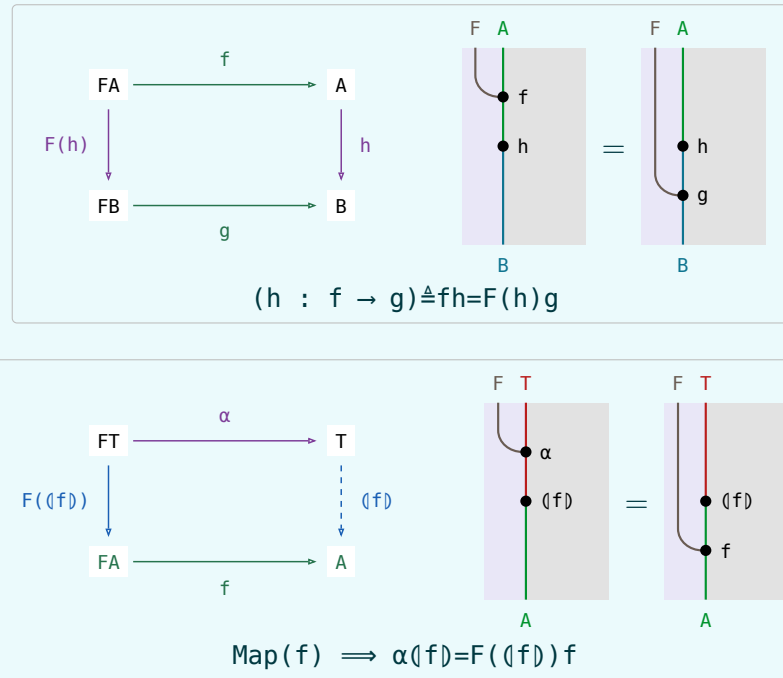
§2.4. Constructing datatypes

§2.5. Products and coproducts

§2.6. Initial algebras

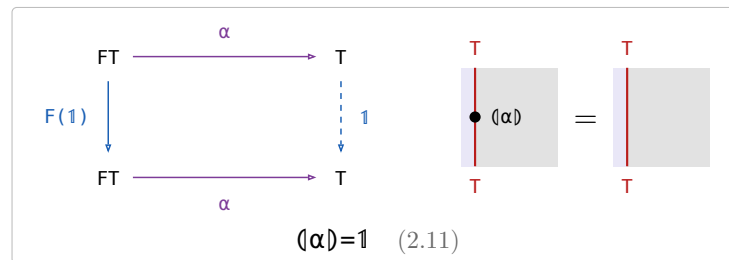
(2.6a)

An **F-algebra** is a map $f : F(A) \rightarrow A$; A is its **carrier**. An **F-homomorphism** from $f : F(A) \rightarrow A$ to $g : F(B) \rightarrow B$ is a map $h : A \rightarrow B$ with $f \circ h = F(h) \circ g$. The **initial algebra** $\alpha : F(T) \rightarrow T$ is the F-algebra with exactly one F-homomorphism $\llbracket f \rrbracket : T \rightarrow A$ to every F-algebra f .



§2.6.1. Reflection

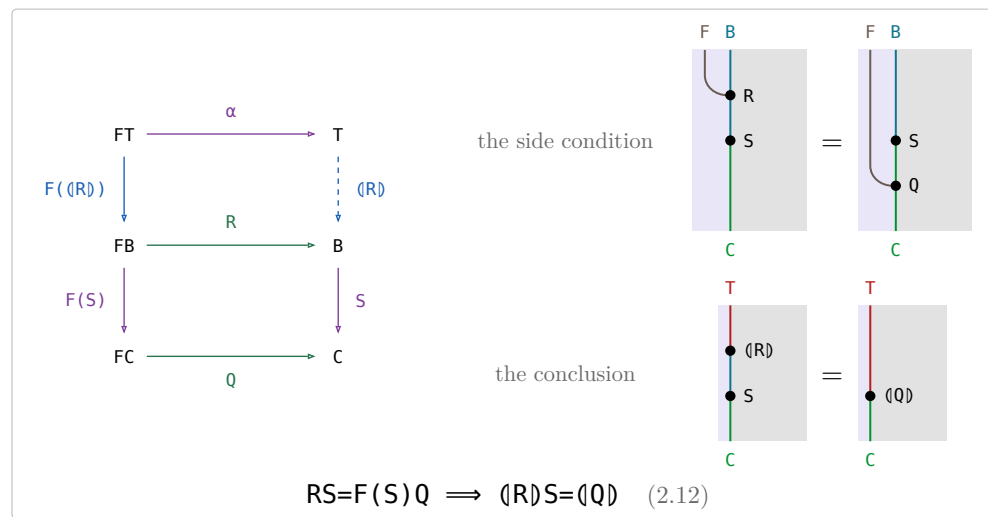
(2.6.1a)



Taking a value apart with α and putting it straight back is doing nothing.

§2.6.2. Fusion: $\llbracket R : FB \rrbracket$ absorb $S : R \rightarrow Q$ (in $\text{Alg}(F)$) and becomes $\llbracket Q \rrbracket$

When $S : B \rightarrow C$ is an F-homomorphism from $R : F(B) \rightarrow B$ to $Q : F(C) \rightarrow C$, folding with R and then applying S is folding with Q .



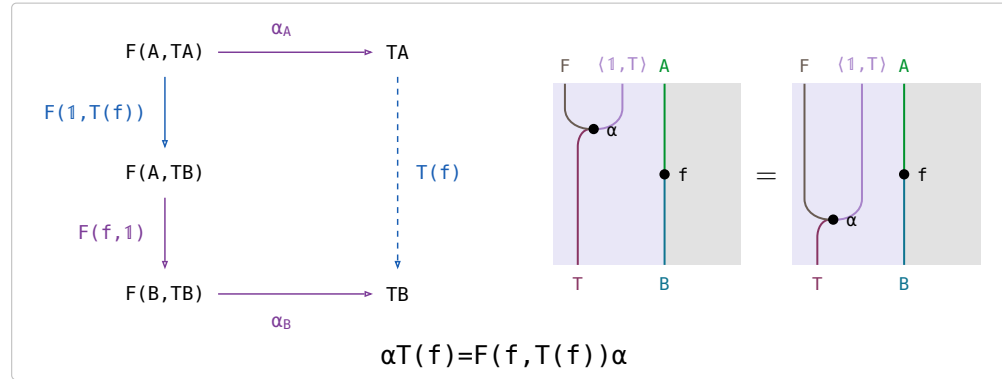
§2.7. Type functors

(2.7a)

Let F be a bifunctor taking both the parameter A and the recursive position TA , with an initial algebra $\alpha_A : F(A, TA) \rightarrow TA$ for every object A . Then T is a functor, acting on a map $f : A \rightarrow B$ by

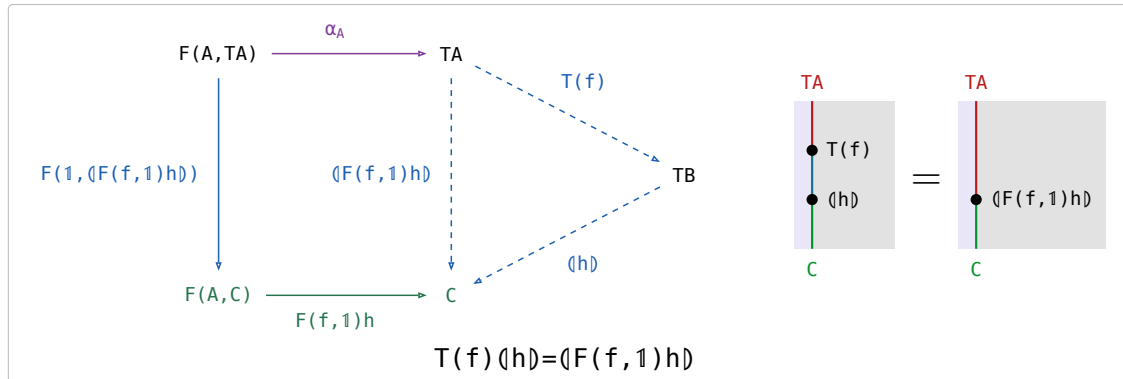
$$T(R) \triangleq (F(R, 1) \alpha)$$

(2.7b)



- $F : \mathcal{A} \times \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}$ is a bifunctor and a wire is a unary functor, so the two arguments are packed first: $\langle 1, T \rangle : \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{A} \times \mathcal{A}$ sends A to (A, TA) , and $F(\langle 1, T \rangle(A))$ is $F(A, TA)$.
- The picture is three wires — F , $\langle 1, T \rangle$, and the object — and the region between the first two is $\mathcal{A} \times \mathcal{A}$.
- α is then an ordinary natural transformation $F \circ \langle 1, T \rangle \Rightarrow T$: its bead eats the F and $\langle 1, T \rangle$ wires, and the T wire is born under it.
- $F(f, T(f))$ costs no notation. It is the bead f on the object wire with $\langle 1, T \rangle$ and F running past: $\langle 1, T \rangle$ is what turns f into the pair $(f, T(f))$, and F is what applies it.
- The law is the naturality of α , which is exactly the freedom to slide that f bead past it.

(2.7c)



(2.7d)

name	law	what it says
functor	$T(1) = 1$ and $T(R)T(S) = T(RS)$	Acting by the identity changes nothing, and two actions in a row are one action.
type functor fusion	$T(f) (F(f, 1)h) = (F(f, 1)h)$	A relator action followed by a fold is a single fold — the intermediate structure is never built. The side condition holds because F is a bifunctor — $F(R, 1)F(1, (Q)) = F(R, (Q)) = F(1, (Q))F(R, 1)$.
naturality of α	$\alpha T(f) = F(f, T(f)) \alpha$	Building and then mapping is the same as mapping the parts and then building, so α is natural from $G(R) = F(R, T(R))$ to T .